

Ice Rainbow

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Synopsis: As the Cold War reaches its zenith, the stories of a Soviet defector, a CIA agent and US Navy pilots unfold as they attempt to uncover a deeply buried secret out within the expanse of the Bering Sea.

Characters:

Part 1 - The Defector

- Captain Anatoly Vronski
- Captain Miles “Mercury” Marshall
- Dolos

Part 2 - The Freighter

- Agent Norman Hatcher
- Agent Maria Ivanov
- Agent John Lewis
- Agent Mark Campbell
- Agent Robert Winters

Part 3 - The Island

- Captain Jack “Weasel” Nills
- Lieutenant Brian “Bozo” Jackson
- Captain Miles “Mercury” Marshall
- Captain Patrick “Poseidon” Dawson
- Captain Joe “Gizmo” Earls
- Agent Robert Winters

Plot:

Prologue

On an island in the Bering Sea, Captain Patrick “Poseidon” Dawson and Captain Joe “Gizmo” Earls gaze at two polar bears fighting over the flesh of a dead seal. Patrick believes they’re fighting for power rather than hunger but Joe scoffs and says they’re just hungry animals. Patrick discusses the moral implications of their mission but Joe lectures ostensibly on the ideals of democracy, freedom and individual rights and says that sacrifice might be necessary to defend those values. He elaborates on his anti-communism thoughts, its suppression of individualism and its inhumanity. Patrick wonders if what they’re doing here can even be considered humane and downgrades the US’s dogmatic teachings. But Joe refutes his claims, blindly asking him to trust his country and subtly implies that he should strengthen his national identity through nationalism

rather than patriotism. Crossing that thin line between these two ideologies is what Patrick always tried to avoid but Joe firmly believes they fight for what they know is inherently right.

Part 1 - The Defector

June 1983 at Yelizovo Air base: it is Captain Anatoly Vronski's daughter's birthday and he is celebrating it with his squadron. Unaware that the cake is laced with sleeping pills, the squadron members eat it and fall asleep. Anatoly packs up his belongings, which include the book **"Meditations"** by Marcus Aurelius, and prepares to leave. At dawn, during shift change, he knocks the mechanic of his Mig-29 unconscious and steals the aircraft. As he flies over the Bering Sea, he is detected by a Beriev A-50 airborne radar which sends two nearby Mig-31s for interception. Anatoly manages to deflect the Mig-31s' missiles through countermeasures and once he passes over the Bering Strait, the Mig-31s are chased off by two F-14s, piloted by Captain Miles "Mercury" Marshall and Lieutenant Brian "Bozo" Jackson.

He is escorted to Naval Air Facility Adak where he announces himself as a defector, saying he knows some sensitive information on the Soviets. He is told that a CIA aircraft will be coming to pick him up in the morning and he is to be kept on Adak in custody until then. When Anatoly asks to speak with Miles alone, he reveals he is a sleeper agent for the CIA and has uncovered a secret organization which threatens the US.

Miles dismisses his claims as nonsense but Anatoly begs Miles to let him escape so that he can meet with a trusted CIA contact, Dolos, in a nearby town on Adak island tonight. He knows the secret organization has infiltrated the CIA and he fears that whoever is coming to pick him up tomorrow might instead be coming to kill him. He knows Dolos can be trusted since he obtained this information via encrypted long-distance telegrams from his wife, which only he and his wife can decode. He conveys his fears to Miles about how his defection could affect his family but says that if he hadn't defected, worse things would happen to them.

Sensing his sincerity, Miles reluctantly agrees to aid his escape. When Anatoly pulls some sleeping pills from his jacket, Miles notices his book "Meditations" but pays no heed to it. Using the sleeping pills, Miles drugs the guards in front of Anatoly's room by spiking their cups of coffee. But before rejoining Miles, Anatoly secretly slips the book into Brian's bedroom whilst he's sleeping. The book starts with a handwritten note saying, "Don't trust anyone. If I disappear, it's because of what's in there." With the note comes hints on how to decode the elusive and cryptic hand-writings written across many pages.

The duo steal a jeep and make their way into town. At a pub, surprisingly bustling late that night, they meet Dolos, who has been patiently waiting for Anatoly's arrival. After a tense exchange, Dolos finally reveals what Anatoly feared most: his supposedly trusted contact is in fact covertly working for the secret organization he has uncovered. Shockingly, so does Miles, who has led the defector straight into a trap. All the pub patrons are, in fact, also agents working for Dolos. Anatoly is baffled, saying it was his wife who warned him about this organization, instructed him to defect, and asked him to contact Dolos in that pub. It's inconceivable to him that his wife would betray him. Dolos reveals he encrypted their communications in such a way Anatoly would believe he is receiving long-distance telegrams from his wife (their only means of communications since Anatoly

is stationed far away from where she lives). Dolos knew that after having previously tapped into their coded telegrams and decrypting them. He reveals Anatoly's wife is dead and his relatives will now suffer from his defection.

Anatoly suffers a silent breakdown and emptily stares at Dolos, knowing he is about to meet his death. Dolos disparages him for being a communist at heart and a lousy sleeper agent. He says Anatoly's defection was necessary since he couldn't be reached in Yelizovo, a highly secured Soviet base. He describes the hardships his family will have to go through due to his defection, all of which will be in vain. Anatoly feels lost, having foregone his national identity, and not knowing where he truly belongs. Having fallen straight into his trap, Dolos takes out his pistol and mercilessly fires straight into Anatoly's head.

Though Miles agrees that the US's values and ideals must be protected, he ponders on whether such bloodshed is necessary. Dolos insists the ends justify the means and that he feels detached from the moral implications of his job. He is a nihilist and doesn't believe in the ideals of whoever he is working for, CIA or otherwise. He just does what he does because he is good at it, it pays well, and it satisfies his thirst for power and control. Miles leaves, having become increasingly disillusioned by Dolos' twisted moral compass.

Part 2 - The Freighter

In **April 1983** at an apartment in Moscow, ex-CIA agent Norman Hatcher and KGB agent Maria Ivanov lie naked on their bed, cuddling each other. Norman defected to the Soviet Union and is living there under a fake name with Maria, who believes she has honey-trapped Norman into giving sensitive CIA information. They discuss the legend of **Theseus and Ariadne**, which encapsulates Norman's fear of betrayal and abandonment. They both have conflicting ideologies regarding democracy and communism but Norman justifies his defection by recounting what led to this drastic decision. He talks about losing his national identity and idealist view of the US after an assignment in Iran:

In **December 1982** in Iran during the Iran-Iraq war, Norman recounts to his contact and only friend, Agent John Lewis, about his overwhelming nuclear anxiety, especially the threat of **MAD (Mutual assured destruction)** and its blatant absurdity. He suffers from paranoia, triggered by US President Ronald Reagan's attempts to discredit the anti-nuclear/peace movements as well as refuting the **Nuclear freeze campaign**. He is crippled by his isolation and loneliness and his fear that his parents might be in danger due to the looming nuclear threat.

He serves as a liaison for the covert sale of arms to Iran by the US. He believes this is to secure the release of American hostages held in Lebanon by Iranian-backed groups but becomes disenchanted on learning part of the profits will be transferred to Nicaraguan Contras, in spite of the Boland Amendment. All the paranoia and the lies fed to him make Norman question his role as a CIA agent. Agent Lewis insists that Norman should behave as a patriot and have faith in his country's actions even if they go against his principles but Norman retorts that such blind allegiance is closer to nationalism than patriotism. Norman tries to follow the principles of stoicism and often reads "**Meditations**" by Marcus Aurelius during his free time. He favors emotional detachment at

things he can't control, such as a potential nuclear war even if this often results in a clash between his fears and the stoic mindset he's trying to achieve.

One day at the Chabahar Port, Norman inspects Iran's new weapons obtained from an Israeli ship serving as intermediary between the US and Iran. He then discovers a Soviet freighter, the MV Mikhailov, containing three disassembled Iranian F-14s bound for an unknown destination. He stealthily takes a few pictures and relates his discovery to Agent Lewis, who finds out that these F-14s have allegedly been destroyed by Iraqi aircrafts. A few days later, Agent Lewis instructs Norman to meet him at the port since he seems to have come across valuable information concerning the freighter, which he discovered is heading to the Bering Sea.

That night, Norman is visited by their superior, Agent Robert Winters (**revealed to be Dolos in Part 1**), who commands Norman to kill Lewis after learning he is in fact a GRU mole. If he refuses, Robert will do it himself. Norman almost suffers a mental breakdown, being faced with a moral dilemma between killing his only friend and strengthening his position as a CIA agent or abandoning his mission and facing backlash from the CIA. Despite his scruples, he goes to the port, finds Lewis in a car, and shoots him dead before he can even reveal what he has uncovered. Having exited the car, Norman crumbles on the ground, traumatized and heartbroken. At the port, he finds that the MV Mikhailov is now gone. A few days later, Robert instructs Norman to abandon his investigation on the MV Mikhailov and reassigns him to Moscow. However, Norman doesn't tell Robert about what Agent Lewis had told him: the MV Mikhailov's destination aka the Bering Sea.

Back in **April 1983**, Norman recounts how Agent Lewis' death made him question the morality and inhumanity of the CIA and served as a catalyst to his defection. Moreover, his relationship with Maria is a cure to his persistent loneliness, since he became emotionally attached to Maria and even gives her his book "**Meditations**" as a gift. Similarly, Maria has a story about losing someone she cared about:

In West Berlin in **February 1983**, with her husband far away and struggling with her loneliness, Maria begins a sexual relationship with MI6 Agent Mark Campbell. Mark was a mole planted by the KGB and Maria served as his handler. Their relationship evolved and Maria found herself unwillingly attached to him. Then one day, Mark was found dead in his apartment. She reveals he was killed by the MI6 after they found out about his treason and since then, Maria has vowed revenge on the assassin who did it.

Back in **April 1983**: Norman asks Maria about the MV Mikhailov, hoping to learn more about why Lewis was killed upon learning the freighter is heading to the Bering Sea. He becomes paranoid by suspicions that Agent Lewis' assassination was a CIA plot to silence him after he discovered something he shouldn't have. He gives Maria the pictures of the ship he took in Iran and she promises to relate her discoveries if ever she learns more about the freighter. The pair is also working on an investigation into three missing R-36s ICBMs but the Russians' inquiry is so far fruitless.

Norman then meets up with Robert, who is also in Moscow and serves as his CIA handler. As it turns out, Norman is working as a **double agent** for the CIA and he was tasked to find out what the KGB knows about the missing R-36s. Robert tells Norman that an Iranian covert agency is responsible for the theft and a

clandestine ship, the Persian Kura, will sail through the Caspian Sea to deliver the missiles to Iran. However, US agents will be ready to intercept the ship once it reaches Iranian shore. Norman then tells Robert about his side investigation into the MV Mikhailov to gauge what the CIA knows about it. But Robert seems dismayed by this and pleads with Norman to abandon his search to focus on his present mission. Robert's trepidation about the ship leads to Norman's increased paranoia. Who can he really trust at this point?

Meanwhile, Maria finds that the MV Mikhailov is almost identical to the MV Petrov, a Soviet cargo ship which sank a few years ago. She tracks down the family of the ship's commander, Captain Kuznetsov. The family is still grieving their loss but when Maria gets hold of their bank statements, she finds they are receiving a considerable sum of money from a shipping firm based on the Vostochny Port. She flies there and whilst scouting the port, she is baffled to find the MV Mikhailov intact, with the missing R-36s in its cargo hold.

She discretely manages to apprehend Captain Kuznetsov, revealed to be still alive and living under another name. Without an ounce of remorse, she tortures him and forces him to divulge what he knows. Fearing for his family, he makes Maria promise that she will protect them. He then declares that the ship is heading towards an island in the Bering Sea, in US territory, and the R-36s will be used on US soil after an American pilot based on the island had told him about it. He was told a secret organization infiltrated the CIA. They are behind all this and the CIA can no longer be trusted, since it's unknown who exactly inside the agency are the members of this secret organization. The pilot, whose name he doesn't know, had told Kuznetsov to relate the location of the missing R-36s to Soviet authorities but he had been warned by a group of mysterious CIA agents to remain dead and not contact anyone, including his family. Otherwise, they would be murdered.

Norman contacts his KGB handlers and tells them about the Persian Kura. As a matter of fact, Norman is a **triple agent** working for the KGB after they had discovered, in Agent Campbell's apartment, a list of some CIA double agents operating in the Soviet Union. They threatened to kill his parents through GRU agents in the US (supported by photographic evidence that they're ready to kill his parents at any time) if Norman doesn't divulge everything he learns from the CIA.

When Maria returns to Moscow, she contacts her MI6 handlers to inform them about the R-36s' location and their possible usage on US targets. She too, much like Norman, has been quite deceptive, since she serves as a double agent for the MI6. She lied to Norman about the MI6 murdering Mark, knowing very well that it was a KGB job after someone had tipped them off that Mark was a triple agent. Her hidden agenda for working for the British intelligence is to find who betrayed Mark and exact her revenge on them.

During her exchange with the MI6 handlers, a group of unknown agents erupt from a car that had been following Maria and gun down her MI6 handlers whilst Maria narrowly manages to escape. Fearing for her life, she goes back home, notes down her knowledge about the R-36s and the secret organization in the book **"Meditations"** in handwritten code and sends it by mail to her husband, Captain Anatoly Vronski. She also sends him a coded telegram to tell him that she will be relaying information about what is truly going on through similar telegrams once she learns more on what is happening.

Norman is suddenly apprehended by the KGB after his tip about the Persian Kura led to a dead end. They believe Norman obtained it from American intelligence trying to divert the KGB's attention. He successfully escapes them after a fierce shootout and briefly reunites with Maria. He confesses he is a triple agent and Maria insists that Norman uses the information she collected about the actual location of the missing R-36s and their possible usage on US territory to convince the KGB he isn't a quadruple agent working for the CIA.

Norman is chased again but this time the KGB agents manage to get hold of him. He is about to be killed until Norman reveals the real location of the R-36s, saving his own life. As they leave, taking Norman as their prisoner, US agents (who had been on Norman's tail and led by Robert) mercilessly gun the KGB agents and apprehend Norman.

They take him to an abandoned warehouse where the agents reveal that they're working for **The Rainbow**, a covert cell operating within the CIA. Robert claims that Norman's true employer has **always** been The Rainbow since what happened in Iran. Agent Lewis had discovered the MV Mikhailov's destination through the ship's logs and had to be silenced. Norman's mission was to find out what the Soviet knew about the missing R-36s and distract them from where they really are. Robert knew Norman was a triple agent since he was aware of Agent Campbell's list, which he had ordered to be planted in Mark's apartment. Norman being a triple agent for the KGB was all according to Robert's plan, to feed the KGB with false information. He knew Norman, being weak and easily manipulable, would tell the KGB about the Persian Kura, distracting them from where the R-36s actually are. They also know about Maria's trip to the Vostochny Port after she had been sighted there with Captain Kuznetsov. When Norman reveals that the R-36s will be used on US targets and that The Rainbow should stop that, Robert says **this is all part of their plans**.

Norman sets up a meeting with Maria, saying he knows who killed Agent Campbell. He gains her trust by telling her that Mark was murdered by a KGB agent and not by the MI6, something Maria hadn't told him. It turns out Norman gained the confidence of his KGB handlers by giving them British routes supplying Iraq with weapons and telling them that Agent Campbell is a triple agent for the MI6 (information he received from the CIA). Norman was then tasked by the KGB to personally assassinate Mark Campbell in West Germany to prove his allegiance. They chose Maria as Norman's handler so that if Norman goes rogue, Maria could potentially be asked to kill Norman after the KGB would have shown her proof of his involvement in Mark's murder, which would have been blamed on another agency. After the murder, Robert and his men planted the list in Agent Campbell's apartment, to be found by the KGB.

At the meeting point, Norman is nowhere to be seen. Alas, Maria belatedly realizes she has been trapped. The Rainbow agents readily capture her and brutally torture her. They intercepted the telegram she sent to her husband and now forces her to reveal how to decrypt it. Unable to bear the immense physical and psychological agony of her torture, she caves in.

Norman becomes furious and disillusioned at The Rainbow's true intentions of using the missiles on US targets, feeling like it contradicts everything he has been fighting for, his ideologies and his morality. He labels The Rainbow as being a terrorist group and refuses to become part of that, despite Robert's insistence to devote

his loyalty to the organization. Robert pressures him to adopt moral disengagement and to displace responsibility to their superiors, since they are behind all this and it is not within their control. Robert dehumanizes everyone who threatens his interests and bears no guilt for hurting them. He accuses Norman for not abiding by the guidelines of stoicism, namely to act rationally and accept his fate. But Norman retorts that the book also describes how one should act in accordance with their principles and values, something he has been unable to do as a spy.

Knowing his parents will be killed, Norman gives up his allegiance, which has become blurred to the point of becoming unrecognizable. His conflicting ideologies have resulted in a standstill where he can no longer process what is right or wrong. Since he now knows too much and is unwilling to cave to Robert's demands, the latter kills Norman.

Part 3 - The Island

Christmas 1983: Somewhere on the Bering Sea, the aircraft carrier USS Dwight D. Eisenhower is on high alert, especially after information concerning the **Soviet nuclear false alarm incident** surfaced. But most recently, an E-3 Sentry has been shot down, allegedly by an unmarked F-14, near the Bering Strait. US Navy pilots Captain Jack "Weasel" Nills, Lieutenant Brian "Bozo" Jackson and Captain Miles "Mercury" Marshall are tasked by the Admiral to come up with a strategy to find out what's happening and hopefully uncover and eliminate the unmarked F-14's base of operation. They are assisted by Robert Winters who reveals some intel about Patrick, a US Navy pilot who disappeared over a decade ago and is suspected to have defected to the Soviet Union. He suspects the whole thing might be a Soviet operation aided by Patrick.

Brian comes up with a strategy to fish out the enemy using a KC-135, masquerading as an E-3, and having 3 ally F-14s under its belly, thus forming a single signature on enemy radar. At night, on the eve of the mission, Jack and Brian meet up for a chat on the current state of the Cold War. Jack is suffering from PTSD following the horrors he witnessed during the Vietnam war after his jet was shot down behind enemy lines. His experiences made him cold and apathetic. He is a cynic and only feels a connection to Brian, his best friend who has always helped him through his emotional turmoil. Having both participated in **Able Archer 83**, they have divergent opinions of the nature of a preemptive strike. It's very apparent Brian is an idealistic and good-natured person who is against bloodshed and striking first. He believes all conflicts can be resolved diplomatically and shares what he uncovered through the book, "**Mediations**", which Anatoly had given him. He claims that the CIA is compromised and there might be a conspiracy threatening the US and the Soviets might be behind it. Brian hasn't decoded everything that's in the book yet but he's close. This information worsens Jack's mental state, feeling like he's on the verge of losing his sanity.

The next day, the 3 take off on their F-14s and rendezvous with a KC-135 from Eielson Air Force Base. Nothing happens for quite a while and they need to refuel. **Back to the night before the mission**, Robert visits Miles' quarters and informs him that Brian has to die. Miles is tasked to ensure Brian and the KC-135 will be destroyed during mid-air refueling. Miles seems distraught by this but knows that refusing this assignment might endanger his life. Robert says that after the explosion, a rogue F-14 will probably be coming to intercept them and they

have to destroy it since that F-14 is suspected to be piloted by Patrick, who Robert suspects is trying to expose The Rainbow's plans. Miles then visits Brian and feels intensely conflicted about confessing Robert's plans. He doesn't and simply wishes Brian good luck for their forthcoming mission. Whilst in his quarters, he notices Brian has the book "**Meditations**".

Back to the refueling of Brian's F-14 (the first to refuel), Miles purposefully fires his engines before Brian, sending the latter in a jet wash. Brian's wing collides with the tanker, causing a massive explosion which pulverizes the KC-135 and damages Brian's F-14. Now discovered, an unmarked F-14 (piloted by Patrick) intercepts the squadron. A dogfight ensues and Miles is shot down by Patrick acting as self-defense. He manages to successfully eject from the flaming aircraft along with his RIO. Jack and Patrick's dogfighting skills are both tremendous but Patrick manages to damage Jack's F-14, causing a fuel leakage, although he oddly refuses to eliminate him.

Miles and his RIO splash down on the ocean and the RIO suspects Miles to have purposefully sabotaged the mid-air refueling. Realizing his RIO will send him straight to court-martial, Miles drowns him and awaits the rescue party whilst despairing over what he has just done. Patrick escorts Brian's damaged jet to Eris Island where they land. Brian instructs his RIO to guard the plane while Patrick secretly guides Brian, posing for a new Rainbow pilot, into the base.

Brian is puzzled to find it occupied by Americans and not Soviets as he originally expected. He also finds old F-4 Phantoms, stolen Tu-95 bombers, and missile silos scattered across the base. Patrick explains he is the base's leader and he's working for The Rainbow, an organization founded in the 60s shortly after JFK's death. Their purpose is to perform a **false flag** nuclear attack (coined **Operation Ice Rainbow**) on US soil with Soviet ICBMs as justification for a preemptive nuclear strike (and a decapitation strike) on the USSR that would annihilate most of the country. After launch, satellites would photograph the stolen Soviet R-36s as they fly to deliver their payload on a major US city as well as select US ICBM launch sites.

Contrary to Brian's biased theory that The Rainbow might be an independent Soviet terrorist organization which somehow managed to infiltrate the CIA, Patrick divulges that The Rainbow is funded and approved by the US government and under the command of some CIA, DoD and US Navy officials as well as the President of the United States. He cites **Operation Northwoods** and **Operation TPAJAX** as precursors that inspired Operation Ice Rainbow. Brian becomes horrified by all this and vows to expose the organization to the public. Patrick's goal by shooting down the E-3 was a desperate attempt to lure unsuspecting US Navy pilots to the base, hoping that at least one of them isn't affiliated with The Rainbow. Patrick lied to Joe and the rest of his team by claiming he was on routine patrol when he instead went to shoot down the E-3.

Patrick explains that due to the secrecy and remoteness of the island, it's been increasingly difficult to supply their jets with parts and maintain the airworthiness of their aircrafts. This is why only **two** F-14s are operational (Patrick's and Joe's). Normally, disguised fishing vessels from Alaska affiliated with The Rainbow provide the island with necessary supplies to ensure its viability. The reason they use American jets is to deter Soviet aircrafts from coming near the island. As for US aircrafts which approach the island not associated with The Rainbow,

the situation is more complex and a decision to intercept them depends on the base leader's assessment of the situation.

Jack approaches the island and radar officers alert Joe, who has been in a deep slumber. The pilot jumps on his F-14 to intercept Jack. After an intense dogfight, Jack obliterates Joe's F-14, undoubtedly killing everyone onboard. He then finally reaches the island and whilst circling the base, he finds Brian's jet on the tarmac...

The **night before the mission**: Jack confesses to Robert about what Brian has uncovered through Anatoly's book. Jack is also working for The Rainbow and his prime motivations are that it would eliminate all conflicts with the USSR and he wouldn't have to deal with the fear of a potential World War 3 ever again, even if it's at the cost of American lives. Robert assesses that the Admiral of the aircraft carrier doesn't know anything about The Rainbow, which will make getting rid of Brian on his own ship a hassle. He purposefully recommended Jack and Miles to the Admiral for the mission since they're the only pilots affiliated with The Rainbow on the ship but Brian was the Admiral's pick. He thus instructs Jack to eliminate Brian during their mission but Jack refuses, unable to kill his best friend. Robert understands his reluctance but nevertheless reiterates that if ever the secret base on Eris is compromised, he will have put his emotions aside and bomb the island into oblivion.

Back to **present**, Jack instructs his RIO to eject due to low fuel disabling their jet from returning to the carrier. After he does so, Jack battles himself over whether to destroy the base or not but sadly concludes he will have to do it, which will most certainly result in the death of his best friend. He relentlessly bombs the base, killing almost everyone there, including Brian. He then ejects and lands on the shores of Eris, awaiting rescue. Back on the carrier, Miles has since been rescued and more rescue parties are on the way towards Eris Island. Robert breaks into Brian's quarters and finds that the book "**Meditations**" is gone.

Emerging from the flames that now rage over the island, Patrick, severely burnt, approaches Jack with his service pistol. Jack reunites with his RIO who berates him for destroying the base without the Admiral's greenlight when suddenly, Patrick shoots at them. Jack's RIO is killed and just when Patrick is about to murder Jack, the latter, in a desperate attempt to save himself, shouts out that he has read Patrick's files and knows what happened to his wife,

He reveals that after The Rainbow made Patrick "disappear", his wife remarried and is now living peacefully with her children. Patrick is happy for her and explains he agreed to lead Ice Rainbow under the promise of a political career once the operation ends. But perturbed by the moral implications of a false flag nuclear attack, he tried to leave. The Rainbow obviously dismissed his resignation and threatened to harm his wife if he abandons his post. His idealistic beliefs changed and he now no longer understands who the true enemy is. On the other hand, Jack recounts how his PTSD shaped his ideology which later came into conflict with his morality. He vouches for any attempts to end a war, regardless of the number of victims on either side but knows this is morally wrong. But Patrick insists that even Operation Ice Rainbow wouldn't have prevented a MAD scenario, claiming the Soviets are always capable of a second strike. Jack realizes his prime motivation for destroying the base was a deeply rooted desire to end all the madness of Ice Rainbow once and for all.

Now with their base of operation destroyed, Patrick theorizes that the whole operation will be blamed on the Soviets and American defectors whose true allegiance will be buried. He knows the public will never become aware of Ice Rainbow and history will be rewritten to ensure the operation never existed. He expresses remorse for his life choices, which only led to pain and suffering. He gazes at a pack of polar bears walking peacefully in the distance and feels strangely comforted. Now glad his wife has moved on and realizing his existence plus what he has done might endanger her life, he shoots himself in the head. Jets fly overhead and helicopters approach the scene as Jack stands besides Patrick's body, silently awaiting rescue.

Epilogue

Months later, Miles returns to his apartment in New York after a meeting with an NYT journalist and finds Robert waiting for him in the shadows. Miles has stolen Brian's book "**Meditations**" before Robert could get his hands on it and he now plans to disclose to the public his knowledge about Ice Rainbow, supported by the now decoded contents of the book to strengthen his credibility. A philosophical discussion ensues where Miles pontificates on the contradictions of **Kantian ethics** in the context of the Cold War and Ice Rainbow. The maxim of killing one's own people to justify taking drastic actions against the enemy violates the idea of the **categorical imperative**, since this maxim cannot be universalized without disintegrating the moral fabric of society. Robert retorts with **utilitarianism**, saying Operation Ice Rainbow would ensure the survival and welfare of the majority of US citizens in spite of necessary sacrifices.

He explains how the subjectivity of truth and its malleability would ensure the preservation of the US's reputation after decimating the Soviet Union. He supports his claims with references to Nietzsche's **perspectivism** and how history would have been rewritten to justify the US's actions. Miles calls him a pawn but Robert affirms his "Will to Power" is what makes him stand out in a world where the master-slave morality prevails. He explains that his codename "Dolos", based on the Greek spirit who impressed Prometheus with a forged statue, exemplifies how good he is at deception. He laughs as he ponders on whether Anatoly would have known he was heading straight into a trap if he had bothered looking up what "Dolos" means.

Whilst Miles disagrees with The Rainbow, he kept following their orders for **survival** rather than because he shares their ideologies. His morality has been contradicted too many times which is why he now aims at exposing The Rainbow to the public, to let the people know the length their government would have gone to ensure its victory. Fearing for his life, Miles asks Robert what's going to happen now. Robert simply replies, "It doesn't matter. History will tell another story."

The End